

水分と 服薬の 介助

Hydration & Medication — Drinks and Giving Medicine Safely — Scenario Dialogue

Can-do: Offer a drink, help a resident sip safely, and give the right medicine at the right time — watching for choking every step.

1 · Dialogue & Why — 会話

Hana
(caregiver)たなか ちゃ も
田中さん、お茶を お持ちしましょうか。

Tanaka-san, shall I bring you some tea?

Why: お持[も]ちします is the humble form of 持[も]つ ('to bring') — お + stem + します lowers yourself to offer service, exactly right for staff. Adding 〜ましょうか turns it into a gentle offer ('shall I...?') rather than just announcing it. Offering fluids matters: elderly residents dehydrate (脱水[だっすい]) easily because they feel thirst less.

Tanaka-san
(resident)すこ のど かわ
ええ、少し 喉が 渴きました。

Yes, I'm a little thirsty.

Why: 喉[のど]が渴[かわ]く ('the throat gets dry') is the normal way to say 'be thirsty' in Japanese — you rarely say it with a word for 'thirsty' alone. Hearing 喉[のど] (throat) and 渴[かわ]く (to get dry) together is worth memorising as a set.

Hana
(caregiver)お すわ すこ の
では、起きて 座りましょうか。少しずつ 飲みましょうね。

Then let's sit up. We'll drink little by little, okay?

Why: Sitting upright (座位[ざい]) before drinking is the #1 rule against 誤嚥[ごえん] (aspiration) — drinking while reclined sends liquid toward the airway. 少[すこ]ずつ ('little by little') and slow pacing stop the resident from gulping. Notice you invite with 〜ましょうか / 〜ましょうね, never an order.

Tanaka-san
(resident)

ありがとう。おいしいわ。

Thank you. It's nice.

Why: The resident answers casually — わ here is a soft, warm sentence ending common in older women's speech. You keep your polite/humble language even though she speaks plainly to you; that one-way politeness is normal in care.

Hana
(caregiver)たなか ひる くすり いま の
田中さん、お昼のお薬です。今 飲んでも いいですか。

Tanaka-san, here's your lunchtime medicine. Is it okay to take it now?

Why: Saying the resident's name and the medicine out loud ('田中[たなか]さん、お昼[ひる]のお薬[くすり]です') is 本人確認[ほんにんかくにん] — confirming the RIGHT person and the RIGHT time, out loud, so you never mix up residents' medicine (誤薬[ごやく]). 飲[の]んでもいいですか asks consent ('may I? is it okay') — you never put medicine in someone's mouth without a yes.

Tanaka-san
(resident)

はい、お願いします。

Yes, please.

Why: お願い[ねが]います ('please; I ask this of you') is the everyday phrase for accepting help or making a request. It's one of the most useful phrases in the whole language — you'll say it and hear it constantly.

Hana
(caregiver)

お水と一緒にどうぞ。ゆっくりで大丈夫ですよ。

Please take it with water. No rush — take your time.

Why: Pills go down safely 一緒に[いっしょ]に ('together') with enough water — dry-swallowing risks the pill sticking or going the wrong way. どうぞ warmly offers, and ゆっくりで大丈夫[だいじょうぶ] removes any pressure to hurry, which is both kinder and safer against 誤嚥[ごえん].

Hana
(caregiver)

ちゃんと飲み込みましたか。お口に残っていませんか。

Did it go down properly? Nothing left in your mouth?

Why: 飲[の]み込[こ]む = 'to swallow'; 飲[の]み込[こ]めましたか is the potential form ('were you able to swallow?'). ALWAYS confirm the swallow — a pill left in the mouth or a wet, gurgly voice afterward is a choking warning. Checking 'anything left?' (残[のこ]っていますか) is a standard safety step before you move on.

Tanaka-san
(resident)

ええ、大丈夫。すっきりしました。

Yes, I'm fine. I feel refreshed.

Why: すっきりする = 'to feel refreshed / clear'. It's a lovely word to recognise — residents use it after drinking, using the toilet, or a bath. Her 大丈夫[だいじょうぶ] confirms the swallow went fine, so you can record it and move on.

2・Key Vocabulary — 語彙

#	日本語	ROMAJI	ENGLISH	メモ / NOTES
1	お茶	ocha	tea	
2	持つ	motsu	to hold; bring	
3	喉	nodo	throat	
4	渴く	kawaku	to get dry (thirsty)	
5	座る	suwaru	to sit	
6	少しずつ	sukoshizutsu	little by little	

7	^の 飲む	<i>nomu</i>	to drink	
8	おいしい		tasty; nice	
9	^{ひる} お昼	<i>ohiru</i>	noon; lunch	
10	^{くすり} お薬	<i>okusuri</i>	medicine	
11	^{ねが} お願いします	<i>onegaishimasu</i>	please (I request)	
12	^{みず} お水	<i>omizu</i>	water	
13	^{いっしょ} 一緒に	<i>isshoni</i>	together	
14	^の ^こ 飲み込む	<i>nomikomou</i>	to swallow	
15	^{のこ} 残る	<i>nokoru</i>	to remain; be left	
16	すっきり		refreshed; clear	

3・Patterns to Reuse — 使える かたち

PATTERN	MEANING & USE
お + [stem] + しまし ょうか	Humble 'Shall I ~ for you?' — お持[も]ちしましょうか, お取 [と]りしましょうか
少[すこ]しずつ ~まし ょうね	'Let's ~ little by little' — safe pacing for drinking/eating
~ても いいですか	'Is it okay to ~? / May I ~?' — consent before medicine or touch
ちゃんと 飲[の]み込 [こ]めましたか	'Did it go down properly?' — always confirm the swallow
~と 一緒[いっしょ]に どうぞ	'Please have it together with ~' — meds with water

4・Practice — れんしゅう

仕事日本語・Shigoto Nihongo

Free video lessons on YouTube · ks-03-hydration-medication

Say / write it in Japanese, then check with the answer key.

#	SAY THIS IN JAPANESE	YOUR ANSWER
1	Offer humbly: 'Shall I bring you some tea?'	
2	Cue safe drinking: 'Let's drink little by little.'	
3	Ask consent: 'Is it okay to take it now?'	
4	Say: 'Please take it with water.'	
5	Confirm the swallow: 'Did it go down properly?'	

5・Answer Key — こたえ

1. お茶^{ちや}を お持ち^もしましょうか。

2. 少し^{すこ}ずつ^の 飲み^のましょうね。

3. 今^{いま} 飲^のんでも いいですか。

4. お水^{みず}と 一緒^{いっしょ}に どうぞ。

5. ちゃんと 飲^のみ込^こめましたか。